

COURSE:	HIST 2301A Canadian Political History
TERM:	Early Summer 2026
PRECLUSIONS:	Precludes additional credit for HIST 2203 (no longer offered)
CLASS:	Day & Time: Mondays and Wednesdays, 14:35 to 17:25 (2:35 pm to 5:25 pm)
	Location: A720 Loeb
INSTRUCTOR:	Kerry Badgley
CONTACT:	Office: Mondays 12:00 pm to 2:00 pm, or by appointment, PA452
	Email: Kerrybadgley@cunet.carleton.ca

- I. **Course Description:** Canadians routinely discuss and participate in politics. In fact, it could be said that politics is almost as popular as hockey, but in the case of the former, there is much more at stake. This is a lecture survey course in Canadian political history that covers the period from Confederation (1867) to the Pierre Trudeau administration. Its primary goal is to ensure that you acquire a solid, factual familiarity with our national political evolution, and the ways in which it has been interpreted by historians. The emphasis is on the historical/chronological evolution of our politics.

The course will build on this chronology by introducing selected themes of Canadian political development, such as political parties, pressure groups, and social movements. We will also evaluate the leaderships traits of our prominent political leaders in order to give you the opportunity to build upon your own leadership awareness and potential.

The focus will primarily be on federal politics, developments in provincial politics will be brought into our discussions whenever relevant. There will be sweeping interpretations as well as detailed case studies that will illuminate the particulars. As well, there will be biographical interpretations of political leaders that demonstrate the impact of personality on politics and peoples.

- II. **Learning Outcomes:** In the process of gaining a solid factual understanding of Canada's political evolution, we will learn the rudiments of all political history; from the multimedia documents and archives used by historians to investigate politics, to the methods, the approaches, and their main themes such as leadership innovation, state formation, party politics, political branding, political dissent and resistance. We will also come to terms with some of the main theories about power, state formation and "national" identity. The course seeks to have students learn by listening, reading, seeing, evaluating, explaining, researching, writing, and reflecting. The course will help students:

1. Acquire an enhanced knowledge about the post-Confederation history of Canada and its political dimensions. This includes key concepts, events, people, points, and arguments.

2. Acquire keys to make sense of present-day Canadian political structures and how they changed over time. In effect, the course hopes to uncover the history behind the headlines and how it has been interpreted (and distorted) from time to time.

3. Learn and use ways to help recover obscured but important collective (and individual) memories.

4. Learn and use the main tools for historical research, and the skills necessary in order to develop as an independent researcher.

5. Acquire skills to resolve historical problems, including the analysis and interpretation of historical documents, and the ability to discern nuances when facing complex questions.

6. Learn and use the basics of “how do we know?” the past: to question myths in the early history of Canada effectively; to be mindful of the history of history (‘historiography’); to make links with history learned otherwise, especially family and community memories.

7. Develop the ability to organize historical discoveries.

8. Use the historian’s tools to present history in written, oral, visual, and digital forms.

9. Practice the collaborative nature of knowledge and positive ways of working collaboratively.

10. Make key linkages between history and other disciplines.

11. Become aware of the ethical issues associated with historical inquiry.

12. Learn the value and joy of historical discovery.

III. **Texts:** The textbook is free and online:

Belshaw, J.D. Canadian History: Post-Confederation. Victoria, B.C.: BCampus, 2015:
<https://opentextbc.ca/postconfederation/>

Readings for each class will be provided on the course’s Brightspace page.

IV **Course Calendar:**

Class 1 (6 May): Introductions – getting to know one another and some basic starting points for the post-1867 period.

Class 2 (11 May): A Transcontinental Dominion

Class 3 (13 May): Industrialization and Responses to the New Order

Class 4 (20 May): Imperialism, Nationalism, and the First World War (**Essay Proposal Due**)

Class 5 (25 May): Indigenous Peoples, and Cracks in Capitalism’s Foundations

Class 6 (27 May) Capitalism's Crisis

Class 7 (1 June): Responses to the Great Depression (**Historical Reflection Due**)

Class 8 (3 June): the Second World War

Class 9 (9 June): The Cold War and Swinging Sixties (**Essay Due**)

Class 10 (11 June): Post-Second World War Social and Technological Changes and Political Implications

Class 11 (15 June) Trudeaumania and Exam Review

Class 12 (17 June) In-Class Exam

IV. **Evaluation:**

Participation:	10%
Essay Proposal (due 20 May):	20%
Historical Reflection (due 1 June):	25%
Essay (due 8 June):	30%
Exam (17 June):	15%
Total:	100%

Late Penalty: Unless otherwise noted, late assignments will be penalized 3% per day (weekends will count as one day). Of course, exceptions will be made for documented medical or other emergencies.

Course Requirements and Assignments: Please note that you are required to complete all of the assignments indicated above in order to pass the course.

For the **Essay Proposal**, you will be marked on the basis of the extent to which preliminary research has been undertaken, the strength of your proposed argument/thesis, and the scholarly sources that you plan on using (minimum three scholarly sources). Full details will be made available on BrightSpace.

For the **Historical Reflection assignment**, you will have a choice: You can either analyze the commemoration of a person or event of political significance, providing arguments as to why it was commemorated, how its interpretation has changed over time, and how (or even if) the person or event would be commemorated today. Conversely, you can make the argument for the inclusion of an individual or a person (or persons) on a Canadian bank note, which will include justifying your position, and explaining any issues that may be associated with the decision. You will be assessed on your historical research of the event or individual, the strength of your arguments, and your organizational and writing skills. The full details for the assignment will be made available on BrightSpace. Length, 250-500 words.

For the **essay**, a list of suggested topics will be circulated in class and posted on BrightSpace. As with the Historical Reflection assignment, you will be assessed on your historical research of your topic (and the scholarly sources you used), the strength of your arguments, and on your organizational and writing skills, Length: 1,500 to 2,000 words.

The **final exam** will be two (2) hours in duration and will cover the full content of the course. The format will be a combination of short answers and essay questions, and the details will be discussed during the review class.

V. Final Grade Approval:

Standing in a course is determined by the course instructor subject to the approval of the Faculty Dean. This means that grades submitted by the instructor may be subject to revision. No grades are final until they have been approved by the Dean.

- VI. **Generative Artificial Intelligence (AI):** AI use in this course: Students may use AI tools for basic word processing functions, including grammar and spell checking (e.g. Grammarly, Microsoft Word Editor, Copilot)

Documenting AI use: It is not necessary to document the use of AI for the permitted purposes listed above. If you have questions about a specific use of AI that isn't listed above, please consult your instructor.

Why have I adopted this policy?: This policy ensures that student voices and ideas are prioritized and authentically represented, maintaining the integrity of the work produced by students while allowing basic support to enhance clarity, correctness, layout and flow of ideas. The goal of adopting a limited use of AI is to help students develop foundational skills in writing and critical thinking by practicing substantive content creation without the support of AI.

Limitations: Students may not use AI for the following tasks: Writing their assignment, essay, or final exam

Note: As our understanding of the uses of AI and its relationship to student work and academic integrity continues to evolve, students are required to discuss their use of AI in any circumstance not described here with the course instructor to ensure it supports the learning goals for the course. Students can also access resources related to citing Generative AI on the MacOdrum Library Website: [MacOdrum Library | Carleton University](#).

VII. Statement on Academic Integrity

Students are not permitted to submit substantially the same piece of work more than once for academic credit. In other words, you are not permitted to simply re-title an assignment from another course for this one, or to make only minor revisions to the original assignment. That said, you are free to build upon the research you have conducted for other courses for your assignments in the class. If you decide to do so, you should cite such work. When in doubt, please consult directly with the instructor.

REGULATIONS COMMON TO ALL HISTORY COURSES

COPIES OF WRITTEN WORK SUBMITTED

Always retain for yourself a copy of all essays, term papers, written assignments or take-home tests submitted in your courses.

PLAGIARISM

The University Academic Integrity Policy defines plagiarism as “*presenting, whether intentionally or not, the ideas, expression of ideas or work of others as one’s own.*” This includes reproducing or paraphrasing portions of someone else’s published or unpublished material, regardless of the source, and presenting these as one’s own without proper citation or reference to the original source. Examples of sources from which the ideas, expressions of ideas or works of others may be drawn from include but are not limited to: books, articles, papers, literary compositions and phrases, performance compositions, chemical compounds, artworks, laboratory reports, research results, calculations and the results of calculations, diagrams, constructions, computer reports, computer code/software, material on the internet and/or conversations.

Examples of plagiarism include, but are not limited to:

- any submission prepared in whole or in part, by someone else, including the unauthorized use of generative AI tools (e.g., ChatGPT);
- using ideas or direct, verbatim quotations, paraphrased material, algorithms, formulae, scientific or mathematical concepts, or ideas without appropriate acknowledgment in any academic assignment;
- using another’s data or research findings without appropriate acknowledgement;
- submitting a computer program developed in whole or in part by someone else, with or without modifications, as one’s own; and
- failing to acknowledge sources through the use of proper citations when using another’s work and/or failing to use quotations marks.

Plagiarism is a serious offence that cannot be resolved directly by the course’s instructor. The Associate Dean of the Faculty conducts a rigorous investigation, including an interview with the student, when an instructor suspects a piece of work has been plagiarized. Penalties are not trivial. They can include a final grade of “F” for the course.

COURSE SHARING WEBSITES and COPYRIGHT

Classroom teaching and learning activities, including lectures, discussions, presentations, etc., by both instructors and students, are copy protected and remain the intellectual property of their respective author(s). All course materials, including PowerPoint presentations, outlines, and other materials, are also protected by copyright and remain the intellectual property of their respective author(s).

Students registered in the course may take notes and make copies of course materials for their own educational use only. Students are not permitted to reproduce or distribute lecture notes and course materials publicly for commercial or non-commercial purposes without express written consent from the copyright holder(s).

STATEMENT ON CLASS CONDUCT

The Carleton University Human Rights Policies and Procedures affirm that all members of the University community share a responsibility to:

- promote equity and fairness,
- respect and value diversity,
- prevent discrimination and harassment, and
- preserve the freedom of its members to carry out responsibly their scholarly work without threat of interference.

Carleton University Equity Services states that “every member of the University community has a right to study, work and live in a safe environment free of discrimination or harassment”. [In May of 2001 Carleton University’s Senate and Board of Governors approved the Carleton University Human Rights Policies and Procedures. The establishment of these policies and procedures was the culmination of the efforts of the Presidential Advisory Committee on Human Rights and a Human Rights Implementation Committee.]

GRADING SYSTEM

Letter grades assigned in this course will have the following percentage equivalents:

A+ = 90-100 (12)	B = 73-76 (8)	C - = 60-62 (4)	F = 0-49 (0) – Failure: no academic credit
A = 85-89 (11)	B - = 70-72 (7)	D+ = 57-59 (3)	
A - = 80-84 (10)	C+ = 67-69 (6)	D = 53-56 (2)	
B+ = 77-79 (9)	C = 63-66 (5)	D - = 50-52 (1)	

The following additional final course grades may be assigned by instructors:

DEF	Official deferral of final exam (see "Petitions to Defer")
GNA	Grade not available. This is used when there is an allegation of an academic offence. The notation is replaced with the appropriate grade for the course as soon as it is available.
IP	In Progress – a notation (IP) assigned to a course by a faculty member when: At the undergraduate level, an undergraduate thesis or course has not been completed by the end of the period of registration.
WDN	Withdrawn. No academic credit, no impact on the CGPA. WDN is a permanent notation that appears on the official transcript for students who withdraw after the full fee adjustment date in each term (noted in the Academic Year section of the Calendar each term). Students may withdraw on or before the last day of classes.

Standing in a course is determined by the course instructor subject to the approval of the Faculty Dean. This means that grades submitted by the instructor may be subject to revision. No grades are final until they have been approved by the Dean.

WITHDRAWAL WITHOUT ACADEMIC PENALTY

May 20, 2026: Last day for a full fee adjustment when withdrawing from **early** summer courses (financial withdrawal). Withdrawals after this date will result in a permanent notation of WDN on the official transcript.

May 31, 2026: Last day for a full fee adjustment when withdrawing from **full** summer courses (financial withdrawal). Withdrawals after this date will result in a permanent notation of WDN on the official transcript.

June 1, 2026: Last day for academic withdrawal from **early** summer courses.

July 15, 2026: Last day for a full fee adjustment when withdrawing from **late** summer courses (financial withdrawal).

August 1, 2026: Last day for academic withdrawal from **late** summer and **full** summer courses and any other courses that end this term.

STUDENT MENTAL HEALTH

As a university student you may experience a range of mental health challenges that significantly impact your academic success and overall well-being. If you need help, please speak to someone. There are numerous resources available both on- and off-campus to support you.

Emergency Resources (on and off campus): <https://carleton.ca/health/emergencies-and-crisis/emergency-numbers/>

Carleton Resources:

- Mental Health and Wellbeing: <https://carleton.ca/wellness/>
- Health & Counselling Services: <https://carleton.ca/health/>
- Paul Menton Centre: <https://carleton.ca/pmc/>
- Academic Advising Centre (AAC): <https://carleton.ca/academicadvising/>
- Centre for Student Academic Support (CSAS): <https://carleton.ca/csas/>
- Equity & Inclusivity Communities: <https://carleton.ca/equity/>

Off Campus Resources:

- Distress Centre of Ottawa and Region: (613) 238-3311 or TEXT: 343-306-5550, <https://www.dcottawa.on.ca/>
- Mental Health Crisis Service: (613) 722-6914, 1-866-996-0991, <http://www.crisisline.ca/>
- Empower Me: 1-844-741-6389, <https://students.carleton.ca/services/empower-me-counselling-services/>
- Good2Talk: 1-866-925-5454, <https://good2talk.ca/>
- The Walk-In Counselling Clinic: <https://walkincounselling.com>

ACADEMIC ACCOMMODATION

Carleton is committed to providing academic accessibility for all individuals. You may need special arrangements to meet your academic obligations during the term. The accommodation request processes, including information about the *Academic Consideration Policy for Students in Medical and Other Extenuating Circumstances*, are outlined on the Academic Accommodations website: [Course Outline Information - Current Students](#)

PETITIONS TO DEFER

Students unable to write a final examination because of illness or other circumstances beyond their control or whose performance on an examination has been impaired by such circumstances may apply within five working days to the Registrar's Office for permission to write a deferred examination. The request must be fully and specifically supported by a medical certificate or other relevant documentation. Only deferral petitions submitted to the Registrar's Office will be considered.

CONTACTS

- Department of History history@carleton.ca
- Registrar's Office registrar@carleton.ca
- Academic Advising Centre academicadvising@carleton.ca
- Paul Menton Centre pmc@carleton.ca
- Centre for Student Academic Support – Study Skills, Writing Tutorials, Bounce Back csas@carleton.ca

Application for Graduation Deadlines

- Spring Graduation (June): April 1
- Fall Graduation (November): August 31
- Winter Graduation (February): November 30